

Python Built-in Methods Cheat Sheet (Interview Ready)

1 General Functions

Function	Example	Output
print()	print("Hi")	Hi
type()	type(10)	<class 'int'>
id()	id(10)	140703264
len()	len([1,2,3])	3
int(), float(), str()	int("10")	10
bool()	bool(0)	False
sum()	sum([1,2,3])	6
min(), max()	max([1,5,3])	5
sorted()	sorted([3,1,2])	[1,2,3]
reversed()	list(reversed([1,2,3]))	[3,2,1]
enumerate()	list(enumerate(['a','b']))	[(0,'a'),(1,'b')]
zip()	list(zip([1,2],[3,4]))	[(1,3),(2,4)]
all(), any()	all([True,False]) → False	

2 String Methods

Method	Example	Output
upper()	"hi".upper()	HI
lower()	"HI".lower()	hi
capitalize()	"hello".capitalize()	Hello
title()	"hello world".title()	Hello World
swapcase()	"PyThOn".swapcase()	pYtHoN

Method	Example	Output
strip()	" hi ".strip()	hi
split()	"a b c".split()	['a','b','c']
join()	" ".join(['a','b'])	a b
replace()	"abc".replace('a','A')	Abc
find()	"abc".find('b')	1
count()	"aaa".count('a')	3
startswith()	"abc".startswith('a')	True
endswith()	"abc".endswith('c')	True
isalpha()	"abc".isalpha()	True
isdigit()	"123".isdigit()	True
isspace()	" ".isspace()	True

3 List Methods

Method	Example	Output
append()	[1,2].append(3)	[1,2,3]
extend()	[1,2].extend([3,4])	[1,2,3,4]
insert()	[1,2].insert(1,5)	[1,5,2]
remove()	[1,2,3].remove(2)	[1,3]
pop()	[1,2,3].pop()	[1,2]
clear()	[1,2,3].clear()	[]
index()	[1,2,3].index(2)	1
count()	[1,2,2].count(2)	2
sort()	[3,1,2].sort()	[1,2,3]
reverse()	[1,2,3].reverse()	[3,2,1]
copy()	a=[1,2]; b=a.copy()	[1,2]

4 Tuple Methods

Method	Example	Output
count()	(1,2,2).count(2)	2
index()	(1,2,3).index(2)	1

5 Set Methods

Method	Example	Output
add()	{1,2}.add(3)	{1,2,3}
remove()	{1,2,3}.remove(2)	{1,3}
discard()	{1,2}.discard(3)	{1,2}
pop()	{1,2}.pop()	removes element
clear()	{1,2}.clear()	set()
union()	{1,2}.union({2,3})	{1,2,3}
intersection()	{1,2}.intersection({2,3})	{2}
difference()	{1,2}.difference({2,3})	{1}
issubset()	{1}.issubset({1,2})	True
issuperset()	{1,2}.issuperset({1})	True

6 Dictionary Methods

Method	Example	Output
keys()	d={'a':1}; d.keys()	dict_keys(['a'])
values()	d.values()	dict_values([1])
items()	d.items()	dict_items([('a',1)])
get()	d.get('a')	1
update()	d.update({'b':2})	{'a':1,'b':2}
pop()	d.pop('a')	1
popitem()	d.popitem()	removes last

Method	Example	Output
clear()	d.clear()	{}
setdefault()	d.setdefault('c',0)	0
copy()	d.copy()	copy dict

7 Functional Built-ins

Function	Example	Output
map()	list(map(lambda x:x*2,[1,2]))	[2,4]
filter()	list(filter(lambda x:x>1,[1,2]))	[2]
reduce()	from functools import reduce; reduce(lambda x,y:x+y,[1,2,3])	6
any()	any([True,False])	True
all()	all([True,False])	False

✓ Interview Tips

1. Memorize **common methods for strings, lists, dicts, and sets**.
2. Know **mutability of data types**.
3. Be ready to discuss **time complexity of operations** (append $O(1)$, insert $O(n)$, etc.).
4. Python 3.9+ supports `|` operator for dictionary merge.
5. Use built-ins to **avoid unnecessary loops** and improve code readability.